conquered his fears to become a brave man—the manner in which men become brave, as Nelson Mandela said. Ratan has displayed bravery in all activities of his life, both professional and personal. If he is challenged he will be equal to the task, provided it violates no rules.

Witness his love for flying, driving, and a lesser-known pursuit, diving. He is a careful driver, but not a slow one. He likes the rush and excitement of speed. Soaring into the sky is as exciting for him as descending into the depths of the oceans, i.e. scuba diving. He started diving in Los Angeles in 1962, he says. He has done it in Hawaii, Fiji, Australia, Midway Islands and Goa, amongst other places. Diving gives a different rush; 'it is like going through an adventure. It is a different world' and one gets to see 'large fish, dangerous fish', he explains with glee.

He has not been too careful while diving. He punctured his ear drum five to six times, he says. This perhaps is the reason why one of the interviewees told me that for Ratan to hear a person who is seated on his right, the individual would have to speak rather loudly. By the 1980s, he was forced to give up diving to prevent further damage to his ears.

Ratan's love for flying, of course, is legendary. He was not content in having got a fixed-wing flying licence early in the US as a student at Cornell. He took to flying helicopters and got his Indian licence before he was twenty-seven, in October 1964. In 2007, at the age of sixty-nine, when he got the opportunity to be the first Indian to fly the F-16 Falcon (Bloc 50) multi-role supersonic aircraft at the Bangalore air show, he was exhilarated. The very thought of flying the famed air superiority fighter 'excites me very much', he said. He took over the 'aircraft controls mid-flight on several occasions' after the aircraft reached Mach 1.3 and climbed to a height of 18,000 feet. Nothing could have excited him more.

Ratan's Legacy

For a man who deep down fears marriage, unsure of how it might work out, Ratan got perilously close to wedlock more than once.

Ratan muddled through a few relationships without the courage to culminate any into marriage. Fearing the unknown, he backed off.

Yet, it is a little unusual that he, his brother, Jimmy, and his sisters, Shireen and Deanna, are all unmarried. When Ratan was asked if there was some link between his decision to stay a bachelor and the divorce of his